

JOANA CASTAÑEDA

LANGUAGES:

Spanish (Native), English (Advanced), French (Conversational)

LINKEDIN: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/joanac>

PORTFOLIO: <https://joanacastaneda.github.io/Portfolio/index.html>

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Digital Designer | UI/UX | QUALITY ASSURANCE

Digital Designer with over **6 years of professional experience** creating user-centered digital experiences for **government institutions, nonprofit organizations, and international companies**. Skilled in graphic design, web design, UI design, digital communication, and quality assurance, combining creativity with analytical thinking and strong attention to detail. Experienced collaborating with multidisciplinary teams, developing digital solutions, and improving user experience through design, usability, and continuous process improvement.

PROFESSIONAL HIGHLIGHTS

- Over **6 years of professional experience** in digital design, web design, and visual communication.
- Unique combination of **digital design, web development, UI/UX, and localization QA experience**, bringing both creative and analytical perspectives to digital product development.
- Strong understanding of **user-centered design, information architecture, usability, and digital communication**.
- **International experience** in localization quality assurance, ensuring linguistic accuracy and high-quality user experiences for global video game projects.
- Creative, detail-oriented professional recognized for problem-solving, adaptability, and cross-functional collaboration.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Graphic & Digital Design:** Branding, visual identity, editorial design, social media graphics, digital content, motion graphics, and video editing.
- **Design Tools:** Adobe Creative Cloud (Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign, After Effects, Premiere Pro), Figma, Canva
- **Web Design:** HTML, CSS, JavaScript, WordPress, Wix, responsive web design, GitHub
- **UI/UX Design:** Wireframing, prototyping, interface design, and user-centered design using Figma.
- **Digital Marketing:** Google Ads, Google Analytics, basic SEO
- **Quality Assurance (QA):** Functional testing, localization testing, bug reporting, documentation, quality control, TestRail, Jira, Jenkins, and Excel.
- **AI Productivity Tools:** AI-assisted design, creative workflow optimization, content generation, and research.
- **Office Tools:** Microsoft Office (Word, PowerPoint, Excel)

EDUCATION

Cégep de Rosemont / *Certificate of French Language Proficiency*

Montreal, Canada 2023-2024

St. Lawrence College / *Game Programming Diploma*

Ontario, Canada 2021-2023

Universidad Autónoma Metropolitana *Bachelor's Degree – Graphic Communication Design*

CDMX 2012-2016

EXPERIENCE

IT Analyst / Digital Designer

November 2017 – July 2021

SAT / (Government institution in Mexico City)

- Contributed to the development of a nationwide campaign promoting formal taxpayer registration by supporting the design and **communication strategy, helping increase registrations**, particularly among small business owners.
- Designed and maintained sections of the institutional website, **improving content organization**, usability, and overall user experience.
- Developed digital solutions and internal web **applications tailored to the operational needs** of multiple departments.
- **Optimized the organization's main web portal**, improving information accessibility and operational efficiency for internal users.
- Produced digital and multimedia content, including videos, tutorials, landing pages, infographics, icons, newsletters, and social media assets.
- **Strengthened internal communication** by designing system alerts, informational newsletters, and digital communication materials.
- Proposed **new audiovisual initiatives** for internal recognition programs, contributing to employee engagement and a stronger organizational culture.

Freelance UI / Web Designer

October 2023 – January 2024

ACOMM / (Freelance project to renovate a website for an organization in Montreal)

- Designed a modern UI booking interface in Figma **to improve usability and accessibility** for a nonprofit organization.
- Collaborated directly with stakeholders to understand business needs and translate them into **intuitive digital solutions**.
- Enhanced user experience through **interface improvements aligned with accessibility** and branding standards.

LQA Tester

January 2025 – July 2026

Altagram Group / (Game Localization company in Montreal, Canada)

- Performed localization **quality assurance for internationally recognized video game titles** translated into Latin American Spanish.
- Identified linguistic, functional, contextual, and visual issues to ensure localization quality and a seamless user experience.
- Documented defects using industry-standard QA tools while collaborating with international testing teams.
- Contributed to projects including **Candy Crush, Dead by Daylight, and Diablo**.

Web Designer

September 2021 – May 2023

We R Unlimited / (Web Agency in Mexico City)

- Contributed to the redesign of Genuino Metco's website, creating a more advanced, user-friendly, and visually cohesive interface, greatly **enhancing the user experience**.
- Designed 6 product-specific mini-sites (AzucarBC, Svetia, Mascabado, DBsugar, Piloncillo, and Sweet-0), each reflecting unique brand identities **while maintaining consistent usability**.
- Collaborated with developers and project stakeholders to deliver responsive and brand-consistent web solutions.

Graphic Designer

2016 – 2017

Goros Lotu / *(Transport Company in Mexico City)*

- **Strengthened the company's visual identity** by designing cohesive digital and printed marketing materials.
- Coordinated with printing suppliers to **optimize production costs** while maintaining high-quality results.

Graphic Designer Volunteer

July 2023 – October 2023

BTSADV / *(Volunteer for a nonprofit organization who helps women in USA)*

- Developed promotional and awareness materials, including flyers and social media graphics, with a strong focus on **brand alignment** and visual clarity to **improve audience comprehension** and retention.